



FREE SAMPLE

MARCHING *STRONG*

Marching Band Rehearsal Workout System

FORTE
ATHLETICS

WELCOME

Built to make your band finish strong.

Marching Strong is a structured strength-and-endurance program built for the demands of marching — no equipment, full ensemble, about 15 minutes at the start of rehearsal.

Three workouts a week, three progressing phases across the season. By the time your show hits its hardest stretch, your members still have fuel in the tank.

Designed to be led by a student or an instructor — not one more thing on your plate.

Built on a proven training system.

Forte Athletics has delivered 117,000+ workouts to athletes through our training platform. *Marching Strong* brings that same movement system — the cues, the progressions, the coaching — to your whole band.

As always — remember to have fun.
This is how *WE* get stronger *TOGETHER*.

YOUR SEASON AT A GLANCE

SAMPLE WEEK:

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		A Strength		B Strength		C Cardio

Two strength days, one cardio day.

Drop them on whichever rehearsal days fit your schedule.

THREE PHASE PROGRESSION:

PHASE 1 : Weeks 1 - 4. Learn the moves, build a base.

PHASE 2 : Weeks 5-8. Add load and complexity.

PHASE 3 : Weeks 9-12. Build power and shorten the rests.

How phases progress

Same movements, raised difficulty. Each phase adds a harder variation, more reps, or less rest — so the work scales with your band as the season ramps.

BEFORE YOU START

Built for everyone, at their own pace.

For healthy members cleared for normal marching-band activity.

Check with a director and physician first if a member has a heart condition, asthma, a current injury, a recent illness, or a doctor's note to limit exercise.

Resting is the strong choice.

Scaling a move down, taking a rest, or sitting out a round is never a failure. Nobody is shamed for it.

The leader's job is safety first.

Keep the group moving safely. Keep the pace reasonable. Speak up the second something looks off. Pausing to check on someone is doing the job exactly right.

A note for directors

*This program is educational, not medical advice. Follow your school's own activity, heat, and medical-clearance policies, and keep qualified staff and emergency procedures in place. **The director is responsible for ensuring a qualified adult supervises every session.***

→ Next page: Heat, Hydration & When to Stop. Read it before any outdoor workout.

HEAT, HYDRATION, & WHEN TO STOP

Heat is the most serious risk here. Treat it that way.

Most of this training is outdoors, often on turf far hotter than the air.

- **Hydrate** before, during, and after — water within reach, breaks built in.
- **Watch the surface.** Turf hits 130–160°F in sun. Move floor moves (Hollow Body, Burpee) to grass, or skip them.
- **Scale with the heat** — cut cardio effort, lengthen rests, skip max-effort intervals.
- **Use shade and timing** — run it in the coolest part of rehearsal.

STOP and get help immediately if a member shows any of these:

- Dizziness, fainting, or confusion
- Nausea or vomiting
- Stops sweating, or skin is hot, red, and dry
- Chest pain, trouble breathing, or a racing heart that won't settle
- A fast-onset headache, or cramps that won't stop
- Says they "don't feel right" — believe them

Move them to shade, give water if they're alert, and get an adult, director, or athletic trainer right now. When in doubt, call for help — you are never wrong to stop.

THE 3-LAYER SYSTEM

You're never guessing.

Every exercise lives in three places.

1. **Learn it — the Videos.** Watch the playlist to learn each move. Leaders watch first to prep; every member is encouraged to watch too.
2. **Reference it — the Exercise Library.** A page per move at the back: setup, the move, what to watch for, the fix. Glance here when form looks off.
3. **Run it — the Workout pages.** The Phase 1/2/3 call sheets you hold during rehearsal: order, cues, dose.

No screen or wifi on the field?

Run the whole thing from the Workout pages + Exercise Library — cues, order, and dose, no video needed. The videos teach it; the pages run it.

[Watch the free training videos here →](#)

If hyperlink does not work, search for the “Rehearsal Workout (Free Sample)” playlist on Forte Athletics YouTube channel.

HOW TO READ A WORKOUT SHEET

(Don't assume members know these terms — many don't.)

What the numbers mean

- **Rep** — one full movement (one squat, one lunge).
- **Set** — a group of reps done in a row without stopping.
- **Counts / rep** — how many beats each rep takes. "4 counts / rep" = the move is spread over 4 beats.
- **Rest** — the break between sets or between exercises (printed on the sheet).
- **L & R / per side** — do the listed amount on each side.
- **Active Recovery** — recover while moving, like with a heel march



Tempo ***Squat***

16 reps x 3 sets
4 counts / rep

Say this for timing

**"Down-Hold-
Drive-Up"**

Quick modifications

Easier: ½ squat
Harder: Arms Overhead

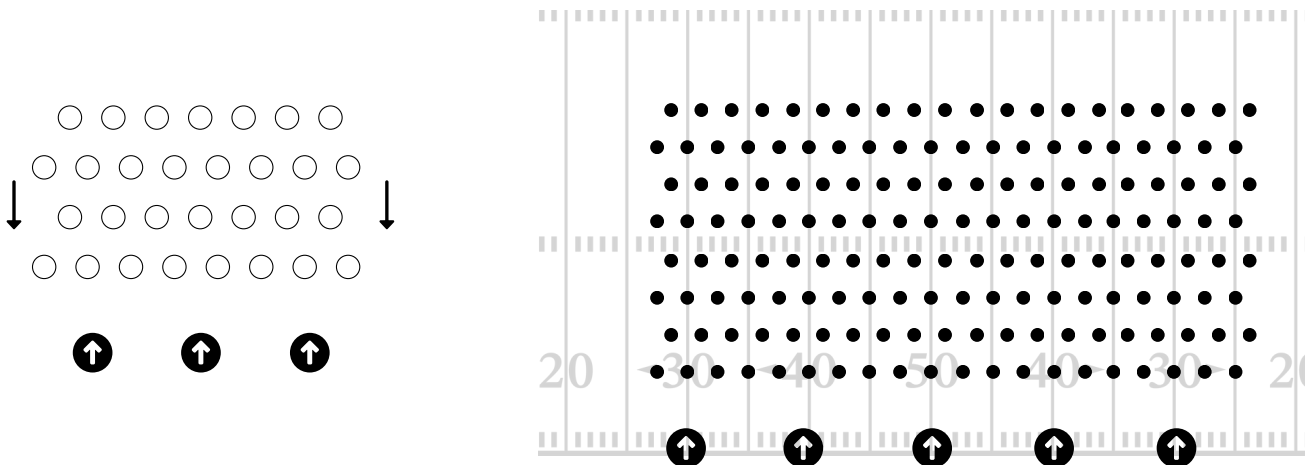
Read it like this

"16 reps x 3 sets · 4 counts / rep" Do the move 16 times (that's 1 set), rest, and repeat until you've done 3 sets. Each rep takes 4 beats. Every card reads the same way.

SETUP & BLOCK FORMATION

Set the block so everyone can see the leader.

- Set up a block with every other row in the windows of the row ahead — so no one is hidden.
- On a field: about four 8-to-5 steps apart, side-to-side and front-to-back.
- Workout leader(s) stand in front, facing the block.



Quick Check

Stand where your leader will stand. Can you see every face? If a member is blocked, nudge their row half a step. Good spacing now prevents form problems later.

RUNNING A SESSION – 7 STEPS

1. **Watch the instructional videos →** — never lead a move you haven't seen.
2. **Set the block** — every other row in windows.
3. **Warm up** — run our **free 10-min Dynamic Warmup →**
4. **Demo, then count** — say the setup, do one rep, give the cues, then start the count.
5. **Call the cue, not a lecture** — "Down-Hold-Drive-Up." Short, loud, on tempo.
6. **Watch one thing** — pick the biggest red flag and watch the front rows.
7. **Stay positive, keep moving** — name good reps, let people rest, get to the next one.

Keep the energy up

Play music (have section leaders build the playlist) and call out good reps by name. When in doubt: smaller range, slower pace — "make it smaller, make it clean."

Workout A - Strength

Move at ~80 bpm — a half-time feel.

9 min · 16 count active recovery between sets · 1 min between exercises

1



Tempo Squat

16 reps x 3 sets
4 counts / rep

“Down-Hold-Drive-Up”

Easier: ½ squat
Harder: Arms Overhead

..... REST 1 MIN

2



Heel Raise w/ Reach

20 reps x 3 sets
2 counts / rep

“Up-Down-Up-Down”

Easier: Legs only
Harder: Archer or single leg

..... REST 1 MIN

3



Hip Hikes (L & R)

8 reps per side
x 2 sets per side
4 counts / rep

“Lift-Lock-Hold-Down”

Easier: Hold a chair
Harder: Arms overhead

Squat

Tempo (P1) · Pulse (P2) · Power (P3)



Set up

- Feet a little wider than your shoulders, toes turned out slightly
- Hands together at your chest

Move

- Sit back like there's a chair behind you
- Keep chest upright
- Spread the floor apart with your feet to drive knees out
- Press the floor away to stand tall



Red flags — watch for → correction

- **Knees caving in** → "spread the floor — push your knees toward the walls" (on the way up too)
- **Heels lifting** → "reach your hips back, or don't drop as low"
- **Back rounding at the bottom** → "Keep your chest up, don't drop as low"



Knees caving in

Modifications:

Easier ↘

Half Squat or Quarter Squat

Harder ↗

Arms overhead

How the squat progresses:

P1 · Tempo

"Down-Hold-Drive-Up"
Pause at the bottom.

The Phase 2/3 squat move is
unlocked in the full program.

Heel Raise w/ Reach

Phase 1 Calf Training



Set up

- Feet under your shoulders, toes forward, stand tall
- Hands on your shoulders, elbows back to open the chest

Move

- Press the floor away to lift both heels — drive through your big toe, don't roll to the outside
- Reach your hands to the ceiling as your heels rise
- Lower slow and quiet — tap the floor, don't drop into your heels (control on the way down is the goal)



Red flags — watch for → correction

- Arms not reaching all the way up → "cover your ears with your elbows"
- Dropping / plopping into the heels → "lower slow and quiet"



Arms not reaching

Modifications:

Easier ↘

lower body only, smaller range, heels closer to the floor.

Harder ↗

one-leg (archer) for balance;
single-leg calf raise

How the calf training progresses:

P1 - Heel Raise w/ Reach

"Down-Hold-Drive-Up"
—Reach to the ceiling as your heels rise.

The Phase 2/3 calf move is
unlocked in the full program.

Hip Hike

Triple Flexion (P1) · W/ Arms Overhead (P2 & P3)



Set up

- One foot in front, just your pinky toe on the ground
- Hands on your hips
- Let that front hip sink down first — feel the stretch on the outside of your standing hip

Move

- Lift your whole front leg up; bend the knee like you're cracking a walnut behind it, toes up toward your shin
- Lift up through your standing hip to raise the other side as high as you can
- Lower slow, sinking that hip back down

Red flags — watch for → correction

- **Toes sagging** (hip and knee lifted, but foot dangling) → "pull your toes up toward your shin and squeeze the whole leg"
- **Leaning the body to the side** → "stack your ear over your foot"



Toes sagging

Modifications:

Easier ↘

Hold a chair for balance

Harder ↗

Arms out to a "T" or overhead "Y"

How the hip hike progresses:

P1 · Hands on Hips
"Down-Hold-Drive-Up"
Pause at the bottom.

*The Phase 2/3 hip hike is
unlocked in the full program.*

THAT WAS 1 of 9.

You just ran Workout A. Here's the full season you unlock with the complete program.

PHASE 1 · A Strength  YOURS	PHASE 1 · B Strength 	PHASE 1 · C Cardio 
PHASE 2 · A Strength 	PHASE 2 · B Strength 	PHASE 2 · C Cardio 
PHASE 3 · A Strength 	PHASE 3 · B Strength 	PHASE 3 · C Cardio 
 Full exercise library	 Video coaching for every move	 Troubleshooting Playbook

You've got everything you need to run Workout A.
When your band's ready for the full season, it's right here.

UNLOCK THE FULL PROGRAM →

forteathletics.net/strong